MIKE DAVIES

Technical team lead · Learning technology, digital tooling and technical training in scientific services

Crewe, Cheshire (CW1) · +44 (0)7701 062610 · Michaeldavies6@icloud.com

Looking for: a team to build and lead, where I can coach and develop people, set the standard for how the work is done, and create something I can call my own and be proud of.

PROFILE

A hands-on technical lead looking for a small team to run. Fifteen years on and around scientific instruments, from building mass spectrometers and installing them on four continents to GxP field service and automation reliability, then a year running operations for a licensed start-up. For the last four years I have built the learning systems, skills data and digital tools behind a global laboratory services academy, leading the people who deliver them: a direct report eight time zones away, matrix teams on large documentation projects, and the apprentices, trainers and local champions who carry adoption on site. I lead the way I train: explain the why, set the standard, build the tool that makes the standard easy to meet, and coach people until they own it. ILM Level 5 qualified in leadership and management.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the people behind a global technical academy's digital learning: line-managed a direct report in San Diego, matrix-managed several colleagues through large controlled-documentation projects, and mentored apprentices, trainers and site champions across Europe.
- Set the training and competency standards a 500-person business runs on in Cornerstone LMS and Talent Coach, and produced or commissioned around 50 eLearning courses since 2022.
- Built the workforce skills matrix from scratch, from Excel and Forms through a Power BI dashboard across 25,000+ pieces of equipment to a matrix covering 300 to 400 engineers, now used for sales decisions, skills gap analysis and choosing who is able to train.
- Delivered digital learning initiatives end to end, from platform evaluation and pilot through analytics and adoption, coordinating IS&T, operations and vendors across sites, on time and in scope.
- Ran operations for a five-person licensed pharma sample facility: took it from paper to phone-based quality apps and wrote its first greenhouse gas report, which went into a client bid that asked for one and won.
- Built the tools the team runs on: a Power Apps document control system for hundreds of controlled documents, a course authoring app that replaced a paid product (about £3,000 a year saved), and a Training Store app published organisation-wide.

CORE CAPABILITIES

- Leading small technical teams: direct, matrix and remote
- Mentoring, coaching and technical training for engineers and technicians
- Project delivery with IT, operations and vendors
- Standards, competency frameworks and audit readiness in regulated environments
- Excel and VBA automation
- Learning management systems (Cornerstone)
- eLearning and instructional design (Articulate Rise and Storyline, Adobe Captivate)
- Training video and animation (Premiere Pro, After Effects, Clipchamp)
- VR and AR experience development (HoloLens, Quest 3, Vuzix)
- Power Platform application build (Power Apps, Power Automate, Power BI)
- AI-assisted application and workflow build (Claude Code, ChatGPT)
- Scientific instrument engineering (quadrupole MS, LC-MS, GC-MS, laboratory automation)
- GxP operations and facility management

EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

- ILM Level 5, Leadership and Management
- ILM Level 2, Leadership and Team Skills, 2019
- ILM Level 2, Public Speaking
- NVQ Level 2, Performing Manufacturing Operations, 2014
- A-levels in Electronics, Physics and Use of Maths, South Cheshire College, 2010
- ICH Good Clinical Practice
- Research and Human Tissue legislation

CAREER HISTORY

CBRE, Full Spectrum Lab Services

Jun 2022 – Present

Knowledge Management Lead · Global, based in Cheshire

- Own the design, deployment and continuous improvement of the technical learning and competency systems for CBRE's global laboratory services workforce, aligned to operational, regulatory and safety standards.

- **People.** Line-manage a direct report in San Diego across an eight-hour time difference, setting objectives, priorities and development remotely; matrix-manage several colleagues through large documentation projects; mentor apprentices, trainers and local champions, mainly across Europe, so that adoption is carried on site rather than pushed from the centre.
- **Delivery.** Run digital learning initiatives end to end, from platform evaluation and pilot through analytics and adoption, coordinating IS&T, operational teams and external vendors across sites.
- **Standards.** Defined the training and competency framework, client standards and configuration requirements for Cornerstone LMS and Talent Coach supporting a 500-person business, delivered through the central LMS admin team; dynamic enrolment and performance tracking.
- **Skills matrix.** Built the workforce capability data model and reporting from scratch: Excel and Forms capture, then a Power BI dashboard across 25,000+ assets, now a matrix covering 300 to 400 engineers used for sales decisions, gap analysis and trainer selection.
- **Content.** Produced or commissioned around 50 eLearning courses, from ten-person site-specific courses to organisation-wide mandatory training.
- **Immersive and media.** Develop VR and AR training experiences and run them on HoloLens, Quest 3 and Vuzix across about twelve sites and 20 to 30 users; produce training video and animation in Premiere Pro, After Effects and Clipchamp; author in Articulate Rise.
- **Tooling.** Built, with AI assistance, the applications the team runs on: a Power Apps and Power Automate document control system for hundreds of controlled documents; a course authoring and player app that replaced a paid product (about £3k a year saved); a Training Store app published organisation-wide; a process mapper; and a library of AI skills automating document production, QA and data enrichment.

Cryoniss
Oct 2021 – May 2022

Facility Manager · Cheshire

- Ran day-to-day operations, facility assets and quality systems for a five-person start-up providing sample storage, specialist logistics and sample handling to pharma under APHA, HTA and MHRA licences; the senior operational role in the business.
- Replaced paper quality records with SharePoint lists and phone-based apps for deviations, improvements and facility checks, so people logged things they previously did not; introduced Teams and Microsoft 365 to the business.
- Produced the company's first greenhouse gas report with a ten-year net zero target. Supplied in a client bid where it had been specifically requested; Cryoniss was the only bidder to provide one and won the work.

CBRE at AstraZeneca
Feb 2017 – Oct 2021

Integrated Systems Specialist, Scientific Technology Advisory · Cheshire

- Provided technical support, documentation and training for next-generation automation in the Global High Throughput Screening Centre, writing tailored maintenance procedures and working directly with OEMs to improve reliability.
- Introduced Microsoft HoloLens for remote maintenance, training and safety surveys, avoiding roughly 20 OEM and engineer call-outs and keeping the centre running through COVID travel restrictions.
- Acted as the technical point of contact between client scientists, engineers and OEMs; trained users and engineers, and drove process improvement and system optimisation that delivered cost and time savings for the client.

CBRE at GSK
Nov 2015 – Feb 2017

Instrument Support Engineer · Hertfordshire

- Preventative maintenance and repair of Agilent and Waters LC-MS and GC-MS systems across multiple GSK sites within GxP and EHS frameworks, plus hydrogen generators and robotic liquid handlers.
- Built Excel and VBA tools that automated work-order distribution, reporting and communications, saving the supervisor about a day a month.

European Spectrometry Systems
Sep 2010 – Nov 2015

Systems Specialist · Cheshire

- Design, production, installation, commissioning, service and repair of quadrupole mass spectrometers for process control, chemical, catalyst, pharma and environmental gas detection: around ten installations or commissionings a year, roughly 40 in total.
- Owned customer relationships end to end: requirements analysis, quotation, installation, training and ongoing support across the UK, Europe, the US, Japan and Australia, often as the sole company representative on site.
- Fed field experience back into product improvements and new products.